

Humana — Deepgram Account Brief

Generated 2026-10-05 · Depth: quick · Fit score: **77/100 (active prospect)** · Legend: [n] = sourced fact · **HYPOTHESIS** = hypothesis, verify · **Unknown** = not found

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TL;DR

- **Who:** Major Medicare Advantage insurer. 20,000+ "member advocates" handle up to **~80M member calls a year** [1].
- **Why now:** Enrollment opens **Oct 15**. ~600K members just got plan-exit letters [3]. The CEO wants to lead with "automation and AI with best-performing vendors" [4].
- **Pain:** **HYPOTHESIS** Google-built Agent Assist helps advocates [2], but nothing resolves calls on its own. Members report 30–45 min holds [8].
- **Motion: Displacement + new use case.** Sell a voice self-service layer (Voice Agent API) and a bake-off vs. Google speech. Switch to **partner co-sell** if their CCaaS is Five9, Amazon Connect, Twilio, or Genesys.
- **Win: Bobby Mukundan** (CTO, Apr 2026) [5] and **Damian Warren** (CDO, Jul 2025) [6]. Both are in their first year, so their roadmaps are still open.
- **Ask:** "Agent Assist makes your 80M calls better. What's the plan for the calls that shouldn't need an advocate at all?"

1. Account Snapshot

Company	Health insurer (MA, Medicaid, Part D) + CenterWell care and pharmacy · Louisville, KY · NYSE: HUM
Scale	20,000+ advocates, ~80M calls/yr [1]. Added ~1M MA members in 2026 enrollment [9]
Strategy	CEO Jim Rehtin, Q2 2026: be "simpler, leaner and faster" and "lead on innovation by leveraging automation and AI with best-performing vendors" [4]
Financial signal	Operating cost ratio down 120 bps YoY through centralization and outsourcing [4]. Exiting weaker MA plans [3]
Relationship	No prior email contact with humana.com found in Gmail

2. Why Now

When	Trigger	So what for Deepgram
Oct 15 – Dec 7	Medicare Annual Enrollment	Biggest call spike of the year. Elastic capacity has a real deadline
Sept 2026	~600K members told their plan ends in 2027 [3]	Wave of repetitive "what happens to my plan?" calls, ideal for automation
Aug 2026	Q2 call: AI "with best-performing vendors" [4]	Executive mandate to buy, not build
Apr 2026	Bobby Mukundan named SVP & CTO [5]	New technical decision-maker
Oct 2025 → 2026	Agent Assist (Google Cloud) rolling out [2]	Contact center is modernizing now. Self-service is the next step

3. Contact Center & Stack

Layer	Vendor (evidence)	Class → implication
CCaaS / telephony	Unknown	Decides direct sale vs. partner co-sell. Discovery Q2

Layer	Vendor (evidence)	Class → implication
Speech engine / IVR	Unknown. <i>HYPOTHESIS</i> likely Google under Agent Assist	Competitor → bake-off on their audio
Agent assist	Google Cloud, Vertex AI / Gemini [2]	Competitor (assist only, no containment)
CRM	Salesforce Health Cloud, 2020 deal STALE [7]	Integration path via function calling
Agent guidance	Balto (vendor's own claim) [10]	Either → find Balto's speech engine

Ops & hiring: "Outsourcing" is a cost lever [4], but the BPO vendors are **Unknown**. Reviews cite long holds and repeat calls [8]. Hiring data is **Unknown** (job boards blocked this run).

4. Buying Committee

Person	Background	Likely role
Damian Warren , SVP & Chief Digital Officer (Jul 2025) [6]	Ex-U.S. Bank head of consumer digital channels	Champion for self-service
Bobby Mukundan , SVP & CTO (Apr 2026) [5]	Ex-CVS Health CIO, ex-JPMorgan global CTO, ex-Accenture	Technical approver; bake-off owner
Japan Mehta , CIO (Feb 2025) [11]	Owens IT, digital & AI, transformation	Approver; AI vendor strategy
David Dintenfass , President, Enterprise Growth [11]	Ex-Fidelity CMO and head of CX design	Exec sponsor for member experience
Contact center leader	Unknown (VP Member Services / Consumer Ops)	Champion with the most enrollment-season pain

5. Pain → Deepgram Fit

Signal	<i>HYPOTHESIS</i> Pain	Deepgram answer + proof
80M calls, AI only assists [1] [2]	Routine calls (ID cards, claims, Rx, provider lookup) burn advocate minutes	Voice Agent API resolves top intents end to end
Seniors speaking member IDs, drug names	Recognition errors push callers to agents	Alphanumeric accuracy. Five9 healthcare client doubled authentication rates [12]
30–45 min holds [8]; enrollment surge [3]	Abandonment, repeat calls, Star-rating risk	Instant answer, 24/7, elastic peak capacity
HIPAA / CMS rules	Compliance stalls AI pilots	VPC / on-prem deployment. Elerian AI (banking, on-prem) [13]

ROI sketch: 80M calls [1] × 30–40% automatable × 50–60% contained × \$3–\$5 saved per call (assumed) ≈ **\$36M–\$96M/yr**. Even the low case, over three years, matches Humana's own \$100M+ Agent Assist target [2].

6. Talk Track & Objections

- **Opener:** "You've shown with Agent Assist that AI pays off across 80 million calls. Deepgram helps health plans take the next step: voice agents that resolve routine calls before they reach an advocate."
- **Angles:** *CTO/CIO:* a bake-off on Humana's own audio vs. Google, run in their VPC. *CDO:* voice becomes a digital channel with the same intents as the app. *Contact center:* coverage for enrollment and January peaks.
- **Proof:** Five9 healthcare client doubled authentication rates [12]. Abby Connect runs an AI receptionist handling 100K+ calls/month [14].

Objection	Response
"We have AI: Agent Assist with Google."	That improves human calls. We remove the calls that don't need a human. The two work together.
"We're standardized on Google."	Keep Gemini as the LLM (bring your own LLM). Compete on accuracy, latency, and cost, measured on their calls.
"Seniors won't talk to a bot."	Natural speech beats press-1 menus. Offer an instant zero-out to an advocate and measure CSAT.
"We're consolidating vendors."	Replace IVR speech and BPO spend, or deliver through the CCaaS partner they already pay.

7. Discovery Questions

1. What share of the ~80M calls are routine intents, and how are they handled today?
2. Which IVR / CCaaS platform sits in front of the advocates, and when is the contract up?
3. Who owns voice self-service for 2027: Digital, IT, or Operations?
4. Which speech engine runs under the IVR and Agent Assist? Is Google pitching virtual agents?
5. Would you run a bake-off on a sample of real member calls?

8. Next Best Actions

1. **Before Oct 15:** Email Damian Warren with the enrollment / plan-exit surge angle. Ask for 20 minutes with his self-service lead.
2. Send Bobby Mukundan a technical note offering a **500-call bake-off** in their VPC, citing the Five9 authentication result.
3. Ask Deepgram partner teams (Five9, AWS, Twilio, Genesys) whether Humana is a customer. That reveals the CCaaS platform and any co-sell path.
4. Identify the VP of Member Services. Rerun **--deep** before the first meeting.

Fit score: Volume 30/30 · Pain 22/25 · Timing 18/20 · Stack 10/15 · Access 2/10 · Competitor adj -5 = **77/100**

Sources

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